POWERPLAY: CORPORATE WARFARE — CASUAL EDITION RULES

Players: 2 to 5 Players
Play Time: 30–45 Minutes (2 Fiscal Quarters)
Components Used: Same physical cards and tokens from the core *PowerPlay* box.

I. Overview & Goal

Welcome to the **Casual Edition** of *PowerPlay: Corporate Warfare*. You and your rivals are corporate insiders competing across **2 Rounds (Fiscal Quarters)** to acquire Assets, trigger Industry Synergies, and corner the market.

After Round 2, the company holds its **Clean-the-Books** audit and the final **Board Meeting**:

- Any player who still owes an unpaid **IOU** after *Clean-the-Books* is **ridiculed by the Board and cannot win**.
- Among all debt-free players, remaining **Coins**, **full printed Asset value**, and **Influence** are converted into **Power**. The player with the most **Power** is named the **Power Player** and wins!

II. What's In & What's Set Aside (Same Box, Same Cards)

The Casual Edition uses the exact same cards as the Advanced game, with a few components left in the box:

Used in Casual Mode

1. **Action Deck (`40` cards — 20 unique × 2)**:
   - Free to play on your turn (`1 Standard Action`).
   - Resolves its printed **Base Effect** + fires `1` **matching-Industry Asset Synergy** for free.
2. **Reaction Deck (`30` cards — 10 unique × 3)**:
   - Played out-of-turn **only when an opponent's Action or Asset Synergy directly affects you**.
   - Its printed **Mitigation Effect is `[Optional]`**—you may play a Reaction even if its mitigation text doesn't apply, purely to fire `1` **matching-Industry Asset Synergy**!
3. **Tier 1 Assets (`4 Coins` Cost · `0 Power` Floor · `2 Coins` Flat Income)** & **Tier 2 Assets (`8 Coins` Cost · `2 Power` Floor · `+1 IP` Signing Bonus · `4 Coins` Flat Income)**.
4. **Event Deck (`15` cards)**:
   - Remove the 3 Advanced-only Events (`Stimulus Grant` , `Regulatory Crackdown` , and `Credit Freeze`) and return them to the box.
5. **Tokens**:
   - **Coins (`C`)**, **Influence (`IP`)**, and **Power (`P`)** counters/tokens.
   - **Leader Token** (`1`).
   - **Deal Tokens** (`2` per player).
   - **IOU Tokens**.

Set Aside in the Box (Advanced Mode Only)

- **Character Cards** (`8` cards) — *not used in Casual Mode*.
- **Tier 3 Assets** (`10` cards) — *not used in Casual Mode*.
- **Income Dice (`D4 / D6 / D10`) & Reroll Tokens** — *not used; Casual Mode uses predictable flat income!*

- **Bank Loans, Private Equity & `PowerPlay!` Burst Turns** — *not used in Casual Mode.*

III. Setup (3 Minutes)

1. **Starting Resources**: Every player starts with:
   - `1 Power` (`P`)
   - `3 Influence` (`IP`)
   - `10 Coins` (`C`)
   - `2 Deal Tokens`
2. **Starting Hand**: Deal each player `3` **Action cards** and `2` **Reaction cards**.
3. **Starting Tier 1 Asset (`Draw 2, Keep 1`)**:
   - Deal each player `2` **Tier 1 Assets**.
   - Each player chooses `1` **Tier 1 Asset** to place face-up in their play area and places the unchosen card into the Tier 1 discard pile *(in a 5-player game, shuffle the unchosen setup cards back into the Tier 1 deck)*.
4. **Decks**: Shuffle the **Action**, **Reaction**, **Event** (15-card Casual set), **Tier 1 Asset**, and **Tier 2 Asset** decks separately.
5. **First Leader**: Give the **Leader Token** to the starting player.

IV. Anytime Actions (Outside an Active Card Resolution)

At **any time during the game** when a card or auction is not actively resolving, any player may:

1. **Convert Currency (Upward Only)**:
   - Spend `3 Coins` → **Gain** `1 Influence` (`IP`).
   - Spend `2 Influence` → **Gain** `1 Power` (`P`).
2. **Sell an Asset to the Supply**:
   - Discard any Asset you own to the Supply to immediately gain **half its printed cost**:
     - **Tier 1 Asset** (`Cost 4C`) → **Gain** `2 Coins`.
     - **Tier 2 Asset** (`Cost 8C`) → **Gain** `4 Coins`.
3. **Make a Two-Party Deal**:
   - Trade Coins, cards, Assets, or IOUs with another player.
   - To propose/complete a Deal, **give** `1` **of your Deal Tokens to the other player**.
4. **Repay an IOU**:
   - Pay the face value of an IOU (`1 Coin` per Coin IOU, or `3 Coins` / `1 IP` per Influence IOU) to its holder (the Supply or the creditor player) to discard the IOU.

V. Round Structure (Played Over 2 Rounds)

Each of the **2 Rounds** follows these **6 steps** in order:

Step 1: Morning News & Opening Bell

1. **Morning News**: Flip the top card of the **Event Deck** into the Morning Event slot (replacing any previous Morning Event).
   - Each Event has an ongoing or immediate **Effect** and a `+1 Power` **Objective** (each player may claim an Event's Objective at most once while that Event is active).

2. **Opening Bell** *(Round 2 only; skipped in Round 1)*:
   - Each player draws back up to `3` **Action cards** and `2` **Reaction cards** (if below those counts).
   - Reset Deal Tokens to `2` per player.

Step 2: Market Operation (`N + 1` Sealed-Bid Asset Draft)

1. **Pull `N + 1` Assets**:
   - Going clockwise starting with the Leader, each player draws `1` card from either the **Tier 1** or **Tier 2** Asset deck and places it face-up in the Market Row.
   - **Leader Bonus Pull**: The **Leader chooses and draws `1` extra Asset (`T1` or `T2`)** and adds it to the Market Row (so there are always `Players + 1` **Assets** available).
2. **Sealed Bid**:
   - All players secretly select any number of held **Coins** (`0` or more) in their hand and reveal simultaneously.
3. **Drafting Assets (Highest Bid to Lowest — Max 1 Asset Per Player)**:
   - In order from highest bid to lowest (ties broken clockwise from the Leader):
   - Pay your bid Coins to the Supply and take `1` **Asset** from the Market Row:
     - **Tier 1 Asset**: Requires `0 Power` (`Buy Floor: 0 P`).
     - **Tier 2 Asset**: Requires `2+ Power` (`Buy Floor: 2 P`) and immediately grants its `+1 Influence` **Signing Bonus**.
   - **1 Unchosen Card Always Discarded**: Because `N + 1` Assets are pulled for `N` players and each player may take at most `1` Asset, the last bidder still gets to choose between the final 2 cards, and the **remaining unchosen Asset(s) are placed into their tier's discard pile** *(if a player bids `0 Coins`, they do not take an Asset)*.

Step 3: First Player Turns (Clockwise from Leader)

Each player takes **1 Turn** consisting of two quick steps:

A. The Inbox (Optional Card Shopping)

- You may buy up to `1` **Action card** (pay `2 Coins` → draw `2` Action cards, keep `1`, discard `1`).
- You may buy up to `1` **Reaction card** (pay `1 Coin` → draw `2` Reaction cards, keep `1`, discard `1`).

B. Action Phase (`1 + 1` Synergy Ladder)

1. **Play `1` Action Card (Free)** from your hand:
   - **Base Effect (`[Optional]`)**: Resolve the card's printed Base Effect (you may choose to skip it if desired).
   - **Base Synergy (`1` Asset Fire — Free)**: Trigger the **Synergy** of `1` **Asset you own** that matches the Action card's **Primary Industry** (provided your Power meets the Asset's `Use Floor`: `0 P` for T1, `2 P` for T2).
   - **Influencing Decision (`+1 IP` → `2` Total Synergies)**: You may pay `1 Influence` to unlock the Action card's **Secondary Industry** and trigger `1` **additional Asset you own**—giving you `2` **total Asset Synergy fires** in any combination of the card's Primary and Secondary Industries! *(Each individual Asset may fire at most once per Action card.)*

How Reactions & Forced IOUs Work During a Turn

- **Target-Only Reactions (`Chain Cap = 1`)**:
  - When an Action card's Base Effect or an Asset Synergy fire **directly targets/affects an opponent**, **only that affected opponent** may respond by playing `1` **Reaction card** from their hand.
  - **Reaction Mitigation (`[Optional]`)**: The Reactor may apply the Reaction's printed mitigation text (if relevant) **AND/OR** trigger `1` **Asset they own** that matches the Reaction's Industry.
  - **No Reaction-to-Reaction**: No player may play a Reaction in response to a Reaction or a Reaction's Asset Synergy fire.
- **Forced Deficit IOUs (When You Can't Afford a Loss)**:
  - If an attack or Synergy causes you to lose or pay Coins or Influence you do not have, you pay what you have and **must take an IOU** for the missing amount:
    - **Each missing** `1 Coin` = `1-Coin IOU`.
    - **Each missing** `1 Influence (` **IP** `)` = `3-Coin IOU`.
  - **Who Holds the IOU?**
    - If the effect says **"An opponent loses X"**, the IOU is owed to the **Supply**.
    - If the effect says **"An opponent pays you X"**, the **Attacker holds the IOU against the Defender** (and collects from the Defender when the IOU is settled!).

Step 4: Lunch Break (`Afternoon News`)

- Flip the top card of the **Event Deck** into the Afternoon Event slot (replacing any previous Afternoon Event).
- *(Note: There is no Private Equity phase in Casual Mode.)*

Step 5: Second Player Turns (Clockwise from Leader)

- Starting with the Leader, each player takes their **second turn of the round** (`The Inbox` → `Action Phase`).

Step 6: Call-it-a-Night (End of Round)

1. **Flat Asset Income (No Dice Rolls!)**:
   - Every player collects **half the printed cost** of each Asset they own from the Supply:
     - **Each Tier 1 Asset** (`Cost 4C`) → **Generates** `2 Coins`.
     - **Each Tier 2 Asset** (`Cost 8C`) → **Generates** `4 Coins`.
   - *(Apply any active Morning or Afternoon Event income modifiers, minimum `0 Coins` per Asset.)*
2. **Currency Conversion & IOU Settlement**:
   - Players may convert currency (`3C → 1IP`, `2IP → 1P`) and pay off any outstanding **IOUs** (to the Supply or to the player holding their IOU).
3. **Thievery (Round 1 Only)**:
   - At the end of Round 1, the player currently in last place (lowest total Power + converted value; ties broken by current turn order) chooses who receives the **Leader Token** for Round 2.

VI. End of Game: Clean-the-Books & The Board Meeting

After **Round 2** `Call-it-a-Night` finishes, the game concludes with two final steps:

1. Clean-the-Books (Mandatory IOU Settlement)

- Every player holding an unpaid **IOU** must pay it off now using their Coins (and may sell owned Assets to the Supply at half cost— `2C` for T1, `4C` for T2—to raise the needed Coins).
- **Ridiculed at the Board Meeting**: Any player who still has an unpaid IOU after *Clean-the-Books* is **ridiculed by the Board and eliminated from winning** (`cannot be named the Power Player`).

2. The Board Meeting (Final Scoring)

All players who cleared their debts calculate their final **Power Score**:

1. Count your **Power (`P`)**.
2. Convert your remaining **Influence (`IP`)** into Power at **`2 IP = 1 Power`** (floor(IP ÷ 2)).
3. Add the **full printed Coin cost of all Assets you own** (`4 Coins` per T1 Asset, `8 Coins` per T2 Asset) to your remaining **Coins**, and convert that combined total into Power at **`6 Coins = 1 Power`** :

`Final Power Score = Power + floor(Influence ÷ 2) + floor((Printed Cost of Owned Assets + Coins) ÷ 6)`

- The player with the **highest Final Power Score** wins the game and is crowned the **Power Player**! *(Tie-breaker: most remaining leftover Coins/Asset value, then most Assets owned.)*